

REGISTER #22   STAGE: UNDER REVIEW   CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM   REVIEW: AUG 4, 2026   AS OF JUL 24, 2026

# Make the offer to the VP Engineering candidate?

|                           |                     |                       |                             |
|---------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------|
| DECISION OWNER<br>FOUNDER | APPROVER<br>FOUNDER | ESCALATION<br>FOUNDER | CATEGORY<br>THE SENIOR HIRE |
|---------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------|

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS — EVERY CLAIM CITED OR MARKED

Every build estimate in the register since April assumes this hire closes by August (register #19, #22).

“All estimates assume the VP Engineering seat is filled by August.”

m04-006 · ENGINEERING LEAD · BUILD PLAN (REGISTER #19) · APR 9

The debrief doc says 'strong yes' from both final interviewers — and both raised the same concern to the founder separately (logged from the weekly check-in): the candidate has not run a team through a re-platform.

“Strong yes.”

m07-002 · PRODUCT LEAD · DEBRIEF DOC · JUL 3

“Both final interviewers, separately: the candidate has not run a team through a re-platform. Neither wrote it in the debrief.”

m07-005 · WEEKLY CHECK-IN LOG · JUL 7

The concern never reached the debrief.

DETECTED ABSENCE

The debrief doc (Jul 3) contains no record of the concern. Verified against the full document.

The founder told the candidate 'we'll figure out the equity' (WhatsApp, Jul 9); nothing in the comp plan reflects it.

“Comp is close. We'll figure out the equity — don't let that hold this up.”

m07-006 · FOUNDER · WHATSAPP · JUL 9

CONTRADICTION ON THE RECORD

|                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                    |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| “Strong yes — both final interviewers.”<br>DEBRIEF DOC · JUL 3                       | “Both raised the same concern separately: no re-platform experience. It never reached the debrief.”<br>WEEKLY CHECK-IN LOG · JUL 7 |
| The written record and the spoken record disagree. Only the check-in log holds both. |                                                                                                                                    |

WHAT HAPPENED LAST TIME

- The last senior hire closed fast on a figure-it-out-later comp promise (register #11).
- Unwinding it cost a re-grant and a quarter of goodwill.

“Offer closed in nine days on an open-ended equity promise. The corrective re-grant was approved five months later; the note records a quarter of goodwill spent unwinding it.”

REGISTER #11 · OUTCOME NOTE (PRIOR YEAR)

WHAT'S MISSING

- No reference call yet from the candidate's last re-platform — the one reference the recorded concern calls for.

RECOMMENDATION

The offer isn't blocked by the candidate. It's blocked by an unwritten equity promise and an unwritten concern. Price the promise into the offer or retract it explicitly, and make the one reference call before it goes out.

'Figure out the equity' was a range discussion, not a commitment. Recorded as an attributed correction; the Jul 9 message stands in the record.

CORRECTION · JUL 10 · FOUNDER · APPEND-ONLY, ATTRIBUTED

How to read this brief: every claim above traces to a quoted source message (message ID · role · channel · date), to a register entry, or is explicitly marked as inference or detected absence. Nothing is smoothed over. This document is illustrative — one shared fictional company, people shown as roles — and contains no customer data. In a pilot, this brief is built from your own exported conversations.

ILLUSTRATIVE · NOT CUSTOMER DATA · ONE SHARED FICTIONAL COMPANY, ROLES ONLY

ANTHRIE · SAMPLE DECISION BRIEF